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Junie Yu

Sulpicio Nesia Yu Jr. (born January 15, 1959), widely known as **Doc Junie Yu**,^[1] is a Filipino physician and politician from Calape, Bohol.^[2] He is the incumbent Mayor of Calape, having assumed office on June 30, 2025.^[3] A prominent figure in Calape politics for decades, Yu previously served as Mayor from 2007 to 2016.^{[4][5][6]} He subsequently served as Vice Mayor for three consecutive terms from June 30, 2016, to June 30, 2025, winning the elections in 2016, 2019, and 2022.^{[7][8][9]} His career reflects a long-standing commitment to public service, marked by various leadership roles and affiliations with several political parties.

Early life and education

Sulpicio Nesia Yu Jr. was born on January 15, 1959, in Calape, Bohol. He is the son of Sulpicio "Pisong" Yu and Bienvenida "Beding" Nesia.^[10] He completed his elementary education at Calape Central Elementary School (CCES). For his secondary education, he attended Bohol Province Institute (BPI), where he was the class president of the Class of 1975.^[11] He then pursued his medical degree at the Cebu Institute of Medicine, graduating with the Class of 1983.^[12] He became a licensed physician specializing in Family Medicine.^[13]

Yu hails from a family with a significant presence in local politics. His father is Sulpicio T. Yu, a former vice-mayor of Calape (1980–1986).^[14] His uncles include Gerardo T. Yu, a former mayor of Calape

Sulpicio N. Yu Jr.

also known as **Doc Junie Yu**



Dr. Yu at TUPAD profiling and orientation on March 8, 2023

Mayor of Calape, Bohol

Incumbent

Assumed office

June 30, 2025

Preceded by Julius Caesar Herrera

In office

June 30, 2007 – June 30, 2016

Preceded by Ernesto C. Herrera II

Succeeded by Nelson N. Yu

Vice Mayor of Calape, Bohol

(1992–1995);^[15] Gerardo's son, Jesus Yves B. Yu, served as Vice Mayor of Calape (2004–2007).^[16] Another uncle, Vicente Tan Yu, served as a municipal councilor of Calape (2004–2013).^{[16][4][5]} His brother, Nelson N. Yu, also served as mayor of the same municipality (2016–2022).^{[7][8]} Other relatives, such as Vicente Tan Yu's grandson Bill Mark Yu, who served as a councilor of the same municipality (2013–2022, 2025-present).^{[6][7][17][3]}

Medical career

Before dedicating himself fully to politics, Dr. Yu Jr. practiced medicine. He served the community of Calape as its Municipal Health Officer from circa 1991 to 2007.^{[18][19]} His specialization is in Family Medicine.^[13]

Political career

Known publicly as "Doc Junie Yu,"^[1] Dr. Yu Jr.'s political career in Calape spans almost two decades, characterized by his service in the municipality's top executive posts. He has been associated with Lakas-Kampi CMD, the Liberal Party, and, as confirmed by his 2025 Certificate of Candidacy and 2022 election run, the National Unity Party (NUP).^{[7][8][9][2]}

Early public service

Yu's first foray into public office was as the Municipal Health Officer of Calape (c. 1991–2007).^{[18][19]}

First mayoral tenure (2007–2016)

	 In office June 30, 2016 – June 30, 2025
Preceded by	Nelson N. Yu
Succeeded by	Roldan O. Damalerio
	 Personal details
Born	 Sulpicio Nesia Yu Jr. January 15, 1959 Calape, Bohol, Philippines
Political party	<u>NUP</u> (2022-present)
Other political affiliations	<u>Liberal</u> (2013–2022) <u>Lakas-Kampi</u> (2010–2013)
Spouse	 Grace Esperanza Garces (deceased)
Parents	 Sulpicio T. Yu Bienvenida Nesia
Relatives	 Alfredo N. Yu (brother) Amelita N. Yu (sister) Liliosa N. Yu (sister) Judith N. Yu (sister)

Jocelyn N. Yu (sister)

Rowena N. Yu (sister)

Nelson N. Yu (brother)

Mario Ramir N. Yu (brother)

Gerardo T. Yu (uncle)

Vicente T. Yu (uncle)

Dr. Yu Jr. first served as Mayor for three consecutive terms, from June 30, 2007, to June 30, 2016.^{[4][5][6]} He came into office succeeding Ernesto C. Herrera II.^[16]

- In the 2010 local elections, running under Lakas-Kampi, he was re-elected with 12,496 votes (81.40%). His brother, Nelson N. Yu, was his running mate and won as Vice Mayor.
- For the 2013 local elections, he switched to the Liberal Party and was again re-elected as Mayor with 5,239 votes (61.53%). Nelson N. Yu also won re-election as Vice Mayor.

He was succeeded as Mayor by his brother, Nelson N. Yu, at the end of this tenure in 2016.^[7]

Vice Mayor (2016–2025)

Following his terms as mayor, Dr. Yu Jr. served as Vice Mayor of Calape from June 30, 2016, to June 30, 2025, winning elections in 2016 (LP),^[7] 2019 (LP),^[8] and 2022 (NUP).^[9] His predecessor as Vice Mayor was his brother, Nelson N. Yu.^[7]

- In the 2016 elections, he ran for Vice Mayor under the Liberal Party and won with 12,792 votes.^[7] He served alongside his brother who was elected Mayor.
- He was re-elected as Vice Mayor in the 2019 elections, under the Liberal Party, garnering 14,369 votes (89.47%).
- In the 2022 elections, running under the National Unity Party (NUP), he secured another term as Vice Mayor with 11,960 votes.^[9] During this term, he served with Mayor Julius Caesar Herrera (NPC). His brother, Nelson Yu (NUP), also ran for Mayor in this election but was unsuccessful.^[9] In August 2024, The Bohol Tribune reported that the Office of the Ombudsman for the Visayas dismissed corruption charges against Yu Jr., which had been filed by Mayor Herrera related to alleged usurpation of authority in signing contracts of service. The Ombudsman found Yu Jr. acted within his authority as Presiding Officer of the Sangguniang Bayan.^[20] Upon his election as Mayor in 2025, he was succeeded as Vice Mayor by Roldan O. Damalerio (PFP).^[3]

Second mayoral tenure (2025–present)

Dr. Yu Jr. made a successful bid to return to Calape's top post in the May 2025 local elections. Running under the NUP, he won the mayoralty with 11,688 votes (54.59%).^[3] He assumed office on June 30, 2025, succeeding Julius Caesar F. Herrera. His Vice Mayor is Roldan O. Damalerio.^[3]

Personal life

Sulpicio N. Yu Jr. and his late wife, Grace Esperanza Garces-Yu,^[13] had children, including:

- Gaius Sulpicio Garces Yu III, a physician who placed 10th in the October 2023 Physician Licensure Examination.^{[21][22][13]}
- Gay Sophia Yu-Charley, a Gerontology Nurse Practitioner practicing in San Diego, California, affiliated with Kaiser Permanente.^{[23][24][25]}
- Gus Siegfred Garces Yu, owner of GSY Pharma, a drug wholesaler based in Calape, Bohol.^{[26][27]}
- Gayle Suzette Garces Yu, who was previously a registered nurse and represented Bohol in the Miss Philippines Earth 2015 pageant, became a licensed physician in October 2022.^{[28][29]}

See also

- 2010 Bohol local elections
- 2013 Bohol local elections
- 2016 Bohol local elections
- 2019 Bohol local elections
- 2022 Bohol local elections
- 2025 Bohol local elections

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